

PTI

FROM SEA TO MOUNTAIN
The Bharat Jodo Yatra was an inflection point in Rahul's career. Hence, a re-run

open polemic on the Adani question sharp enough for the government to try have him banished from that space through a technical knockout. The enforced ouster from 12 Tughlaq Lane—where he has lived since 2004—only handed Rahul the stage on which to play martyr and perchance made him appear even more as the rival Prime Minister Narendra Modi is wary of.

Before the Supreme Court vindicated his charge of vendetta politics, even his four-month parliamentary exile saw him hog the news in ways distinctly uncomfortable for the BJP, as when he visited Manipur. Over three days in June, braving allegations of being irresponsibly cavalier, he waded into a conflict zone by road, almost inviting and then making excellent agit-prop material out of police blockades on his route. The victims had by then been feeling orphaned by the system for a month, and justly so. What played out on TV news and social media thereafter were scenes of near-rapturous warmth, organic or otherwise, almost as if a saviour had arrived in their midst. Not a lot had been spoken there in the vocabulary of love Rahul had patented, and here he was claiming space and traction for it in a bloodied real-world context. Come January, he will

Will the Bharat Nyay Yatra hold on to the stance of being aloof from electoral politics? Not likely, with the 2024 poll clouds gathering...